MONEY MADE SIMPLE · FREE PRINTABLE

The 7-Day Money Reset

One small action a day, 10 to 25 minutes each. In a week you'll know exactly where your money is, have a safety buffer started and a plan for your debt.

How it works

- **Print this, or fill it in on screen.** Each day has one action, a short checklist and a space to write things down.
- **Do the days in order.** Each one builds on the last. Missed a day? Just pick up where you left off.
- **Keep it rough.** Round numbers are fine. The goal is a clear picture, not a perfect spreadsheet.

Your week at a glance

DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3	DAY 4	DAY 5	DAY 6	DAY 7
Money snapshot	**Cancel one subscription**	**Bill calendar + autopay**	**Three bank alerts**	**Start an emergency fund**	**List debts, pick an order**	**Your weekly number**
~20 min ☐	~15 min ☐	~20 min ☐	~10 min ☐	~15 min ☐	~20 min ☐	~25 min ☐

Tick the box when a day is done.

What you'll need

- ☐ Your phone or laptop, logged in to your bank and card apps
- ☐ Your last two months of statements (the apps have them)
- ☐ A pen, if you printed this
- ☐ Your calendar app, for Days 3 and 7

Why seven small days instead of one big afternoon? Because a 15-minute task is easy to start, and starting is the hard part. By Day 7 you'll have done every piece of a working money system without ever sitting down for a dreaded "budget day".

General education, not financial advice. It doesn't know your situation. If you're behind on payments or dealing with collections, a non-profit credit counselor (in the US, an NFCC member agency) is a good, low-cost next step.

1 Take a money snapshot

~20 min

You can't plan from a vague feeling. Today you write down where every dollar is right now. No judging, no fixing. It's just your starting line.

- [ ] Log in to every account: checking, savings, credit cards, loans, retirement.
- [ ] Write each balance below. For debts, add the interest rate (APR). It's on the statement.
- [ ] Find your **monthly take-home pay**: what actually lands in your account after tax, not your salary.

MY SNAPSHOT · DATE: _____

Account	Type	Balance	APR (debts)

Monthly take-home pay: $ _____

I'm paid: ☐ weekly ☐ every 2 weeks ☐ twice a month ☐ monthly

2 Cancel one subscription

~15 min

Recurring charges are the easiest money to get back, because cancelling once saves you every month after. Most people find at least one they forgot about.

- [ ] Search your last two statements for: *subscription, monthly, renewal, membership, auto-pay*.
- [ ] Check your phone's app store subscriptions page (both iPhone and Android have one in settings).
- [ ] List them below, mark keep or cancel, and **cancel at least one today**.

MY SUBSCRIPTIONS

Subscription	$ / month	Keep	Cancel

Saved per month: $ _____ × 12 = $ _____ a year

3 Build your bill calendar

~20 min

Late fees and missed payments usually come from forgetting, not from being broke. Payment history is the biggest single factor in common credit scores, so make "on time" automatic.

- [ ] List every fixed bill and its due date: rent, utilities, phone, insurance, every debt's minimum.
- [ ] Turn on autopay for at least the **minimum** on every debt. You can always pay more by hand.
- [ ] Put any bill without autopay in your calendar, two days before it's due.

MY BILLS

Bill	Amount	Due (day of month)	Autopay on?

Total fixed bills per month: $ _____

4 Set three bank alerts

~10 min

Alerts catch problems while they're still small: a low balance before it overdraws, a strange charge before it becomes three. Every major bank app has them, usually under Settings → Alerts or Notifications.

- [ ] **Low balance** on checking, below $_____
- [ ] **Large transaction** on every card and account, over $_____
- [ ] **Payment due** reminders on each credit card (in the card's app), _____ days before.
- [ ] While you're there: check whether overdraft "coverage" is on, and decide if you want it.

MY ALERTS

Account or card	Alert	Threshold	Done

5 Start your emergency fund

~15 min

A small cash buffer is what stops a flat tire or a vet bill from turning into new credit card debt. The amount matters less than making it automatic.

- [ ] Open a separate savings account, or a savings "bucket" inside your bank, and name it *Emergency*.
- [ ] Check it's insured: FDIC for banks, NCUA for credit unions (you can look a bank up at fdic.gov).
- [ ] Set an **automatic transfer on payday**. Even $10 or $25 is a real start.

Account: _____

Auto-transfer: $ _____ every _____

First goal: $ _____ by _____ (try $500 first, then one month of bills)

6 List your debts, pick an order

~20 min

Paying a bit extra on everything feels responsible but spreads your effort thin. Pay the minimum on all of them, then send every extra dollar to **one** target. When it's gone, roll its payment into the next.

AVALANCHE

Highest interest rate first. Costs the least interest overall.

SNOWBALL

Smallest balance first. Quick wins that keep you going.

Debt	Balance	APR	Minimum	Order

My method: ☐ Avalanche ☐ Snowball **Target debt:** _____

Extra I'll pay on it each month: $ _____

Can't decide? If one debt has a much higher rate than the rest (say 25% vs 7%), avalanche usually saves real money. If the rates are close, pick snowball and enjoy the early wins. Either way, the plan you stick with beats the perfect one you don't.

7 Find your weekly spending number

~25 min

Everything you've done this week feeds one number: how much you can spend each week on groceries, eating out, gas and fun, with bills, savings and debt already handled.

Monthly take-home pay (Day 1)	$ _____
− Fixed bills (Day 3)	$ _____
− Emergency fund transfer (Day 5)	$ _____
− Extra debt payment (Day 6)	$ _____
− Irregular costs ÷ 12 (gifts, car, renewals)	$ _____
= Monthly spending pool	$ _____
× 12 ÷ 52 = my weekly number	$ _____

Why ×12÷52 and not ÷4? A month is about 4.33 weeks. Dividing by 4 hands you a week of spending money you don't have. If the pool comes out negative, trim the extra debt payment or savings first, then look at the biggest bills.

- [ ] Put a **recurring 20-minute "money check-in"** in your calendar, same time every week.
- [ ] At each check-in: how much of this week's number is left? Anything odd on the statements? Any bills coming?

YOU DID IT

Seven days ago this was a vague worry. Now you know your numbers, your bills run on time, your buffer is growing on autopilot and your debt has a plan. That's a money system. The weekly check-in is how you keep it.

Want the spreadsheet version?

If you'd like Day 7's math done for you every month, I made **The 20-Minute Budget**: a 14-page guide plus a spreadsheet that turns this reset into a 20-minute weekly routine, with a weekly check-in tab and a debt payoff planner. It's my own product, $12, and the link is on the Money Made Simple link page.

Totally optional. Everything in this reset works on paper.

You're getting this because you joined the Money Made Simple weekly email: one money move a week, no spam, unsubscribe any time with the link at the bottom of every email.

General education, not financial, tax or investment advice. Bank features and names of settings vary. © Money Made Simple. Free to print for your own use.